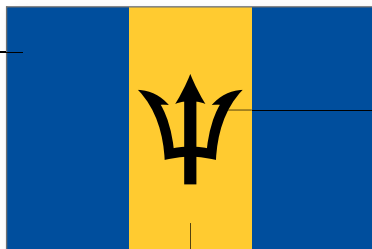


Barbados

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** November 30, 1966 **Usage:** National and Civil

*Blue represents
the sea*



*The broken trident
represents a break
with the past*

*Gold reflects the golden
sands of Barbados*

North America



Barbados was first settled by the British in 1627. It became a colony and achieved self-government in 1961 and independence in 1966.

The current flag was adopted at the time of independence. It was the winning design in a national competition, won by Grantley Prescod, a local art teacher.

THE SYMBOLISM OF THE FLAG

Prescod interpreted the stripes as representing the blue seas and the golden sands which surround the island. The trident is adapted from the previous flag-badge which depicted Britannia holding a trident (symbolic of her rule over the seas). Here the trident is without a shaft, indicating a break with the colonial past. It is also the emblem of the sea god, Neptune, and reflects the importance of the sea to Barbados.

ARMS OF BARBADOS

The coat of arms was granted by HM Queen Elizabeth II in 1966, on a visit to the island. The shield depicts a bearded fig tree, after which the island takes its name, between two “Pride of Barbados” flowers. The crest is an arm holding two sugarcanes in the form of a St. Andrew’s Cross. This commemorates independence, which was achieved on St. Andrew’s Day, November 30, in 1966.

Barbados also has a Governor’s standard. It is the same as that of the Governor of St. Lucia, which features the Royal Crest of England with British lion (*see page 36*), except that it bears the title “Barbados” on the scroll beneath the Royal Crest.